



How Phobos got its stripes

A computer simulation indicated that rolling and bouncing boulders on Phobos' surface may have created the stripes. <https://digit.in/dec18-12-1>



Cloud over Fortnite

Fortnite players spot a mysterious storm cloud on the horizon. They hope for a white Christmas filled with surprises! <https://digit.in/dec18-12-2>

As you have rightly pointed out, technology really has invaded everything. Every. Last. Thing. So it's no surprise to us when our loyal readers write in and thank us for giving them more balanced knowledge of the world, which helps them not just at work, but also socially. Most of our readers tell us that they are pretty well to do in their chosen fields, and that's also not a surprise. Pardon my rant.

Your suggestion for SKOAR! reviews is nice. We really should do that.

You can read all past issues of digit online (I know, it's not the same as holding paper in your hand and flipping pages, but it's better than nothing). Just write to archive@digit.in and you should receive an auto-response which grants you access.

—Robert

 Hi Team Digit! I am a great fan of your magazine. It has made me a "tech geek". I really like your articles. I wanted to get old Fast tracks (not PDF ones), hardcopies. Is there any way I can get them?

—Vaibhav Madan

d As much as we'd love to try and get you older Fast Tracks in print format, we do sell out of them pretty quickly online. People also usually write to help@digit.in and ask for and buy Fast Tracks or dmystifys, or the entire Encyclopedia Technica collection, etc. This means we often don't get replacements for our own copies when we lose them, and we work here! Heck, even Robert doesn't get copies of the mag sent to him in Australia because we've run out – we try to underprint (just short of expected demand) so that there's no paper wastage, and readers always come first.

—Aditya

 Hi Robert, in response to your Article Forbidden Fruit: Yes. I'm 100% not interested to let any Corporate giant know my personal details. Why should they? It's a serious threat to me and my family.

I use Ola for commuting, but I hate the fact that they store all my travel details. If I take an Ola cab to a railway station in order to leave town with my

family, the Ola driver knows that I'm out of station. What if he tries to rob my house? What if he attacks my elderly parents when I am away?

Our parents and forefathers didn't have technology with them. But they always had the best and gave us the best.

—Chaitanya Vangala

d Hi Chaitanya, this is exactly the paranoia I was talking about. For one thing, you do not *have to* use any service. You *choose to*. That choice has consequences. Now, you could do it the old way, and walk into the street at night, find a cab, bring him to your house, load your things and then go to the station or airport. Do you have any details about that driver? When you use Ola or Uber, at least you have their details. If you do get burgled, the police will have all the details about the taxi driver and be able to investigate him as a suspect. Will you be able to provide as many details about the taxi you stopped on the road? Now if it's banking details, be very careful with those...

—Robert



Letter of the Month



Hey Digit, You can never guess for how many of us you've been a part of our life. Most of us like me could never write to you. For me it's because I could never figure out how to express my love for you in few sentences. Keep experimenting with new stuff and at the same time revamping your legacy! My father used to bring the latest edition to home till I was in KV2 Jammu. Then my college JIIT Noida helped me be updated with the latest edition in its library. And now, Kwench subscription in IndiaMART brings me with the latest Digit mag (with full package). I rarely miss any edition of yours and when I do it's because I've promised myself to read every single page of yours in the edition I've with me. I was ready to purchase one from the market (you deserve it) but damn, you're so popular! Like I said, will be back with a full column on you soon. Did I still write a para? (see, that's the problem with you?).

I was writing this only to share my feedback on the new format of short links you provide on top of mag's pages. They are really helpful in case someone wants to know more about

the headline. I'm sure many of your readers, like me, have their browsers open in their mobiles and as soon as they want to enter the short link, they get autosuggestion for digit.in/Month-Year-Page-No. It would be more faster if you don't include page no in the link but adopt something like this - digit.in/Month-Year-link_no. The link_no is simply the counter of the top link not relative to a page. For example, in the issue I'm reading current, instead of digit.in/oct-18-14-2 you could use digit.in/oct-18-4. This way a reader has to use backspace three time less as well as types two/three letter less (including hyphens). This saves a max total of 6 keystrokes. This saves a lot of time and makes very easy to edit and enter the new link faster.

—Paras Lehana



Hi Paras, that's actually a pretty good idea. We're willing to try it out and see if we face any problems with it... but I don't think we will. Since it's too late to change from this issue, let's experiment with this from the January 2019 issue. Thanks for helping us improve and giving us a perspective we hadn't considered before. The mystery gift is yours!

—Mithun

